Qiaosi (Chelsea) Wang Ph.D.

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Research Areas & Interests: Human-Computer Interaction, AI in Education, Cognitive Science, Design, Responsible AI, Computer-Supported Cooperative Work, Social Computing

EMPLOYMENT

2027- **Assistant Professor (Tenure-Track)** | **University of California, Berkeley**
Berkeley School of Education (BSE)

2024-Current **Carnegie Bosch Postdoctoral Fellow** | **Carnegie Mellon University**
Human-Computer Interaction Institute (HCII), School of Computer Science
Mentors: Hong Shen, Jodi Forlizzi

2022 **Research Intern** | **Google Research, Mountain View**
People + AI Research team (PAIR)
Mentors: Lauren Wilcox, Michael Terry

2021 **Research Intern** | **IBM Research, Almaden**
Mentors: Robert Moore, Guang-Jie Ren

EDUCATION

2018-2024 **Georgia Institute of Technology** Atlanta, GA
Ph.D. in Human-Centered Computing (specialization: Cognitive Science)
Thesis: Mutual Theory of Mind for Human-AI Communication in AI-Mediated Social Interaction
Advisor: Ashok K. Goel
Committee: Munmun De Choudhury, Betsy Disalvo, Q. Vera Liao, Lauren Wilcox

2013-2018 **University of Washington, Seattle** Seattle, WA
B.S. in Informatics and Psychology - Cum Laude

HONORS & AWARDS

Oct 2024 Carnegie Bosch Postdoctoral Fellowship ($12k annual research funding)

Nov 2021 Georgia Tech 2021 Foley Scholar Award Winner ($5000 reward)
Highest award for student excellence in research contributions to computing

Aug 2020 Best Student Paper Award at Learning@Scale '20

Feb 2020 Semifinalist in IBM AI Prize Competition - emPrize Team

Jun 2019 Best Paper Award at DIS'19

Jun 2018 University of Washington Dean's List (10 quarters)

PUBLICATIONS

Referred Journal Articles

[J1] **Qiaosi Wang**, Ida Camacho, Shan Jing, and Ashok K. Goel. 2022. Understanding the Design Space of AI-Mediated Social Interaction in Online Learning: Challenges and Opportunities. Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact. 6, CSCW1, Article 130 (April 2022), 26 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3512977

[J2] Betsy Disalvo, Dheeraj Bandaru, **Qiaosi Wang**, Hong Li, and Thomas Plötz. 2022. Reading the Room – Automated, Momentary Assessment of Student Engagement in the Classroom: Are We There Yet?. Proc. ACM Interact. Mob. Wearable Ubiquitous Technol. 6, 3, Article 112 (September 2022), 26 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3550328

[J3] Chia-Fang Chung, **Qiaosi Wang**, Jessica Schroeder, Allison Cole, Jasmine Zia, James Fogarty, and Sean A. Munson. 2019. Identifying and Planning for Individualized Change: Patient Provider Collaboration Using Lightweight Food Diaries in Healthy Eating and Irritable Bowel Syndrome. PACM Interact. Mob. Wearable Ubiquitous Technol. 3, 1, Article 7 (March 2019), 23 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3314394

Referred Conference Proceedings [1]

[C1] Ashok K. Goel and **Qiaosi Wang**. 2026. Is Development of Mutual Theory of Mind Essential for Developing Human-Level AI? Presented at The Thirteenth Annual Conference on Advances in Cognitive Systems 2026 (ACS '26). Edinburgh, United Kingdom.
Inaugural Ada Lovelace Best Paper Award Award

[C2] **Qiaosi Wang**, Jini Kim, Avanita Sharma, Alicia (Hyun Jin) Lee, Jodi Forlizzi, and Hong Shen. 2026. Situated, Dynamic, and Subjective: Envisioning the Design of Theory-of-Mind-Enabled Everyday AI with Industry Practitioners. In Proceedings of the 2026 ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26). Barcelona, Spain. https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3790936 (Acceptance rate: 25.3%)

[C3] Ningjing Tang, Alice Qian*, **Qiaosi Wang***, Esther Howe, Blake Bullwinkel, Paola Pedrelli, Jina Suh, Hoda Heidari†, and Hong Shen†. 2026. Beyond the Single Turn: Reframing Refusals as Dynamic Experiences Embedded in the Context of Mental Health Support Interactions with LLMs. In Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '26). Montreal, QC, Canada. https://doi.org/10.1145/3805689.3806723. *†Equal contribution.

[C4] **Qiaosi Wang**, Michael Madaio, Shaun Kane, Shivani Kapania, Michael Terry, Lauren Wilcox. 2023. Designing Responsible AI: Adaptations of UX Practice to Meet Responsible AI Challenges. In Proceedings of the 2023 ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI' 23). Hamburg, Germany. https://doi.org/10.1145/3544548.3581278 (Acceptance rate: 28.39%)
One of the five papers selected as CHI'2023 Editor's Choice on Human-Centered AI

[C5] **Qiaosi Wang**, Shan Jing, Ashok K. Goel. 2022. Co-Designing AI Agents to Support Social Connectedness Among Online Learners: Functionalities, Social Characteristics, and Ethical Challenges. In Proceedings of the 2022 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS'22). ACM, Virtual Event, USA. https://doi.org/10.1145/3532106.3533534 (Acceptance rate: 21.5%)

[C6] **Qiaosi Wang**, Koustuv Saha, Eric Gregori, David A. Joyner, and Ashok K. Goel. 2021. Towards Mutual Theory of Mind in Human-AI Interaction: How Language Reflects What Students Perceive About a Virtual Teaching Assistant. In Proceedings of the 2021 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '21). Virtual Event. https://doi.org/10.1145/3411764.3445645 (Acceptance rate: 26.3%)

[C7] **Qiaosi Wang**, Shan Jing, David A. Joyner, Lauren Wilcox, Hong Li, Thomas Plötz, Betsy Disalvo. 2020. Sensing Affect to Empower Students: Learner Perspectives on Affect-Sensitive Technology in Large Educational Contexts. In Proceedings of the ACM Conference on Learning at Scale 2020 (L@S '20). Virtual Event. http://dx.doi.org/10.1145/10.1145/3386527.3405917 (Acceptance rate: 25%)
Best Student Paper Award

[1] Note: Peer-reviewed conferences are top-tier publication venues in human-computer interaction and computer science. They are heavily reviewed, highly selective and intended for archival papers only.

[C8] David A. Joyner, **Qiaosi Wang**, Suyash Thakare, Shan Jing, Ashok K. Goel, Blair MacIntyre. 2020. The Synchronicity Paradox in Online Education. In Proceedings of the ACM Conferences on Learning at Scale 2020 (L@S '20). Virtual Event. https://doi.org/10.1145/3386527.3405922 (Acceptance rate: 25%)

[C9] Lauren Wilcox, Betsy Disalvo, Dick Henneman, **Qiaosi Wang**. 2019. Design in the HCI Classroom: Setting a Research Agenda. In Proceedings of the ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS'19). San Diego, CA, USA. https://doi.org/10.1145/3322276.3322381 (Acceptance rate: 25%)
Best Paper Award

Invited Book Chapter

[B1] Ashok K. Goel and **Qiaosi Wang**. 2026. Is Mutual Theory of Mind Essential for Human-Level AI? To Appear In Theory of Mind in Natural and Artificial Intelligence. Springer Nature.

[B2] Sarah E. Walsh, **Qiaosi Wang***, Lance Ying*. 2025. Theory of Mind in Human-AI Interaction. In Handbook of Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence (pp. 1-43). Singapore: Springer Nature Singapore. *Equal contribution.

[B3] **Qiaosi Wang**, Ida Camacho, Ashok K. Goel. 2022. Investigating the Potential of AI-based Social Matching Systems to Facilitate Social Interaction Among Online Learner. Social and Emotional Learning and Complex Skills Assessment. Springer, Cham, 2022. Page 279-298.

Abstract & Extended Abstracts

[A1] Carlos Rafael Catalan, Lheane Marie Dizon, Patricia Nicole Monderin, Hyo Jin Do, and **Qiaosi Wang**. 2026. Useful but Unwieldy: How Software Engineers Perceive the Design of Chain-of-Thought Explanations in Coding Agents. 2026. Poster accepted at the 14th International Conference on Human-Agent Interaction. Osaka, Japan.

[A2] **Qiaosi Wang**, Joel Wester, Marvin Pafla, Minha Lee, Justin D. Weisz, and Mei Si. 2025. ToMinHAI at CUI'2025: Theory of Mind in Human-CUI Interaction. In Proceedings of the 7th ACM Conference on Conversational User Interfaces (CUI '25). ACM, Waterloo, Ontario, Canada. https://doi.org/10.1145/3719160.3728627

[A3] **Qiaosi Wang**, Sarah E. Walsh, Mei Si, Jeffrey O. Kephart, Justin D. Weisz, Ashok K. Goel. 2024. Theory of Mind in Human-AI Interaction. In Extended Abstracts of the 2024 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA'24). ACM, Honolulu, HI, USA. https://doi.org/10.1145/3613905.3636308 (Acceptance rate: 49%)

[A4] **Qiaosi Wang**, Shan Jing, Ida Camacho, Ashok K. Goel. 2020. Jill Watson SA: Design and Evaluation of a Virtual Agent to Build Communities Among Online Learners. In Extended Abstracts of the 2020 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA'20). ACM, Honolulu, HI, USA. http://dx.doi.org/10.1145/3334480.3382878 (Acceptance rate: 41.8%)

Workshop Papers

[W1] Effat Farhana, Maha Zainab, **Qiaosi Wang**, Niloofar Mireshghallah, Ramira van der Meulen, Max van Duijn. 2026. Theory of Mind and Application in Educational Context. Tutorial presented at the 21st Workshop on Innovative Use of NLP for Building Educational Applications (BEA).

[W2] **Qiaosi Wang**, Xuhui Zhou, Maarten Sap, Jodi Forlizzi, Hong Shen. 2025. Rethinking Theory of Mind Benchmarks for LLMs: Towards A User-Centered Perspective. Accepted and Presented at the Theory of Mind Workshop at IJCAI 2025, Human-centered Evaluation and Auditing of Language Models Workshop at ACM CHI 2025 (HEAL@CHI). https://arxiv.org/abs/2504.10839

[W3] **Qiaosi Wang**, Ashok K. Goel. 2022. Mutual Theory of Mind for Human-AI Communication. Accepted and Presented at CHAI@IJCAI: Communications in Human-AI Interaction Workshop at the 2022 International Joint Conferences on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI). https://arxiv.org/pdf/2210.03842.pdf

[W4] **Qiaosi Wang**, Ida Camacho, Ashok K. Goel. 2020. Designing for Agent-Mediated Online Social Connections: Lessons Learned and Potential Challenges. Accepted and Presented at CUI@CSCW: Collaborating Through Conversational User Interfaces Workshop at the 2020 ACM Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW) Virtual Conference.

GRANTS & RESEARCH AWARDS

FEB 2026 OpenAI Mental Health Grant ($80k)
Title: Detecting Relational and Emotional Harms in Mental Health–Adjacent Chatbot Use
Team: Maarten Sap (PI), Hong Shen, Jodi Forlizzi, Qiaosi Wang, Vasudha Varadarajan

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

SPRING 2022 **Graduate Teaching Assistant, Georgia Institute of Technology**
OMSCS - CS6795 Introduction to Cognitive Science (with Ashok K. Goel)
Overall effectiveness: 4.9/5.0

SPRING 2021 **Online Course Development Teaching Assistant, Georgia Institute of Technology**
OMSCS - CS6795 Introduction to Cognitive Science (with Ashok K. Goel)

SUMMER 2020 **Graduate Teaching Assistant, Georgia Institute of Technology**
CS6795 Introduction to Cognitive Science (with Michael Helms)
Overall effectiveness: 4.8/5.0

SUMMER 2019 **Graduate Teaching Assistant, Georgia Institute of Technology**
CS6795 Introduction to Cognitive Science (with Michael Helms)
Overall effectiveness: 4.8/5.0

TALKS & PANELS

2026 **Mutual Theory of Mind for Responsible Adaptive AI Agents in Online Education**
Invited Talk at OATutor Workshop@Festival of Learning, June 2026.
Invited Talk at Workshop on Innovative Use of NLP for Building Educational Applications (BEA)@ACL, June 2026.

Responsible Design of AI as Social Actors in the Online Classroom
Invited Talk at UC Berkeley School of Education, April 2026.

Understanding and Exploring the Design of Socially Aligned Human-AI Interactions
Invited Talk at Samsung Research Philippines, April 2026.
Invited Talk at Nanyang Technological University, Singapore, WKWSCI, April 2026.
Talk at the People and Tech Seminar, University of Chicago, January 2026.

Social Persuasion in Human-AI Interaction: A Theory of Mind Perspective
Invited Guest Lecture at Persuasion and Social Influence class, Nanyang Technological University Singapore, April 2026.

2024-2025 **Theory of Mind for Socially-Aligned Human-AI Interaction**
Invited Guest Lecture at Human-Centered NLP class, Carnegie Mellon University, Oct 2025.

AI and Ethics: The Black Mirror Writer's Room
Guest Lecture at AI for Social Good class, Carnegie Mellon University, Feb 2025

2022-2023

Mental Models in Human-AI Interaction
Organizer and Presenter, Online Symposium, with Georgia Tech, RPI, IBM Research, June 2023.

Designing Responsible AI: Adaptations of UX Practice to Meet Responsible AI Challenges
Invited Guest Lecture at Human-Centered AI class, UC Berkeley Information School, March 2023.

Mutual Theory of Mind for Human-AI Communication
Invited talk at University of Manchester, Nov 2022.
Presenter, GVU Foley Scholar Award Winners Brown Bag Talk, Georgia Tech, Nov 2022.

How Will AI Transform Teaching and Learning?
Panelist, The Chronicle of Higher Education, Nov 2022.

Academic Services

PROPOSAL REVIEW — NSF Proposal Review Panel (2026)

ORGANIZING COMMITTEE — **Workshops:** Theory of Mind in Human-AI Interaction (ToMinHAI) @ ACM CHI 2023, ACM CUI 2025; Mental Models in Human-AI Interaction (MeMoAI): Methods and Challenges in the Generative and Agentic AI Era @ ACM IUI 2027

PROGRAM COMMITTEE — **Conferences:** AAAI Special Track on AI Alignment 2027, EAAI 2027, CHI 2027, DIS 2025, CHI 2025*, FAccT 2024

Workshops: GenAI and ToM in Communicating Agent Workshop @ IJCAI 2025, Bi-Align Workshop at ICLR 2025

PEER-REVIEW — **Conferences:** CHI (2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023***, 2024*, 2026*), ICSR (2024), CSCW (2021*, 2022, 2023, 2025*), DIS (2019, 2022), CogSci (2020) **Outstanding Review*

Journals: Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (PACMHCI, previously CSCW conference), ACM Transactions on Interactive Intelligent Systems (TiiS), International Journal of Human-Computer Studies (IJHCS), International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction (IJHCI), ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (TOCHI), Computers in Human Behaviors (CHB), ACM Transactions on Human-Robot Interaction, International Journal of Child-Computer Interaction (IJCCI)

MENTORING — **Ph.D. Students** Jini Kim (CMU, advised by Jodi Forlizzi and Hong Shen), Ningjing Tang (CMU, advised by Hong Shen and Hoda Heidari), Lingqing Wang (Georgia Tech, advised by Ashok K. Goel)

Master and Undergrad Students Yuyu Yang (CMU), Esther Suh (CMU, now at OpenAI), Mingxi Yan (CMU), Avanita Sharma (CMU, now at Microsoft), Jessica Lin (CMU), Yiqing Zhou (TU-Delft), Carlos Rafael Catalan (Georgia Tech, now at Samsung Research Philippines), Chidimma Anyi (Georgia Tech, now PhD student at University of Florida), Shan Jing (Georgia Tech), Jingying Zeng (Georgia Tech, now at Amazon)

VOLUNTEER — **Student Volunteer** DIS 2019, CSCW 2020 (virtual), CHI 2021 (virtual)

Facilitator for HCC Program PhD Seminar, Fall 2020, Georgia Tech

Undergraduate Research Leader, Undergraduate Research Program, UW

PRESS COVERAGE

JAN 2025 **Meet CBI fellow Chelsea Wang.** *Carnegie Bosch Institute News* (Link).

JUN 2022 **Conversing with AI: Interview with Chelsea Wang about Communications with Artificial Intelligence Systems.** *Ethno-Data Blog* (Link).

JUN 2021 **Q&A: Georgia Tech Researcher Discusses How AI can Improve Student Success.** *EdTech Higher Education Magazine* (Link).

MAY 2021 **New Language Model Uses Texts to Predict How Groups of People Perceive AI Agents.** *Georgia Tech News* (Link).